

Main conclusion

RED — Must change

Natural Earth projection cannot be used as the normal Google Maps basemap. The design's “no Google/provider branding” requirement also conflicts with Google attribution requirements.

AMBER — Needs custom implementation

Automatic label repositioning, the dotted custom map surface, preference-specific visual tinting, and “zoom = business-level navigation” are not standard Google Maps behaviours; they require application overlays/custom logic.

GREEN — Supported

Custom markers, map styling, country boundary fills, fit-to-bounds, coordinates, map interaction, and custom HTML panels are supported.

Important Google requirement

When Google Maps Platform content is displayed, Google Maps attribution must remain visible, legible, unmodified and unobscured. The design should therefore reserve space for Google Maps attribution/logo instead of treating the map as a completely white-label basemap.

- The ability to save selected products
- Saved destination and preference context
- A clear reason to provide an email or create an account
- No generic blog or newsletter promotion

14. Footer

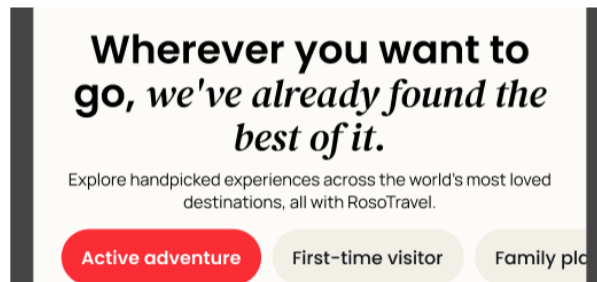
Shows navigation to countries, cities, attractions, categories, customer support and company information.

In short:

- **Countries, cities and attractions:** Destination Discovery Map
- **Categories:** Explore by Interest
- **Categories controlling products:** Explore by Interest + Contextual Experience Shortlist
- **Products only:** Contextual Experience Shortlist
- **Reviews, guides and company information:** Why Travelers Choose Rosotravel

INTERACTIVE Map Visualisation and additional expelnaiton

- **Similar as for country page visualisation only is to show how the model should works and DEE it is not a finished design**
- Important on the design I believe that **Travel Preferences + How We Do It + Destination Discovery Map should be together as you did in one of the variants on 23.07**



Interactive map — level specification

Four zoom levels, one component. Each level answers a different question, shows a different entity type, and is allowed a different amount of commercial detail.

Scope: the map section of the mobile homepage only. Phase 1 is a flat world map. The 3D globe is explicitly deferred to Phase 2.

1 · Principles that hold at every level

Google Maps comments

Section: Map scope / Natural Earth

NOT POSSIBLE with the normal Google Maps basemap. The document asks for a flat world map using the Natural Earth projection. Google Maps uses the Mercator projection for its standard maps. We can style the Google basemap, but we cannot switch the standard Google map to Natural Earth. If Natural Earth is mandatory, we would need a custom map/tile solution instead of the normal Google basemap.

Section: 3D globe deferred

Possible. Google Maps has 3D map capabilities, so simply deferring the 3D globe is a product decision, not a Google Maps limitation.

- 1. **A pin is a recommendation, not a location.** If we have nothing to recommend somewhere, it does not get a pin.
- 2. **We reorder, we never hide.** A destination that does not match the active preference stays on the map with an honest label and an honest reason.
- 3. **One entity type per level.** Countries do not appear at city level; products never appear on the map.
- 4. **Counts are ceilings, and readability outranks them.** Up to 8 cities per country, up to 4 attraction winners per city, 3 products per attraction (4 only where it still reads cleanly). If labels crowd or cards blur together, show fewer — never reduce type size or tighten spacing to fit the maximum.
- 5. **Commercial detail arrives late.** Prices, star ratings and review counts start at level 2 and are only complete at level 3.
- 6. **Every recommendation carries its cost.** A trade-off line is mandatory wherever we make a claim; it is not an optional flourish.
- 7. **The map is an enhancement, not the content.** The list below the map is server-rendered and crawlable, and is the fallback when the map cannot load.

2 · The four levels at a glance

Level	Entities on the map	The question it answers	Commercial detail allowed
L0 World	Countries	Where should someone like me go?	Pick count only. No prices, no ratings.
L1 Country	Cities (up to 8, readability-capped) + attraction clusters	Where in this country do I base myself?	Counts only. Clusters show a pick count, nothing else.
L2 City	Attractions (max 4 winners) + categories	What is actually worth my time here?	Rating, review count and a from price per attraction.
L3 Attraction	The selected attraction + its siblings (3 products, 4 if readable)	Which version of this do I book?	Full product detail: rating, reviews, duration, exact price, CTA.

3 · Level 0 — World

Purpose. Turn a preference into a shortlist of countries, and make the reasoning visible before anything is clicked.

Google Maps comments

Section: Four levels / entity types

Possible. World → Country → City → Attraction can be implemented as application state and map zoom/viewport changes. Google does not require us to show Google's POIs; we can display our own recommendation markers.

Section: Products never appear on the map

Possible. This is controlled by our frontend logic. We simply do not render product markers on the map.

Section: Commercial detail

Possible. Prices, ratings and review counts can remain in our HTML result panel instead of being rendered as Google map content.

Map treatment. Flat world projection (Natural Earth), warm land, pale water, national borders as hairlines. Countries we recommend under the active preference are tinted a half-step warmer than the rest. No provider labels, no city names from the basemap, no roads. The frame is fitted to all covered destinations, so no pin can fall outside the card.

Pins. One per country: a white pill with a coloured dot, the country name, and a badge with the number of picks we hold there. Pill styling encodes the match tier — see section 8. Labels never overlap: they are separated in both axes, and a pin that cannot be placed cleanly is moved, never dropped.

Panel below the map. Destinations ranked for the active preference. Each row: photo, match label, one reason chip, country name with its top city, the “why this fits” line, and the selection figure (*9 picks from 180*). No prices at this level.

Never at this level. Prices, star ratings, availability, urgency copy, or more than one reason chip per row.

4 · Level 1 — Country

Purpose. Answer “where in this country” before anyone starts comparing tours.

Map treatment. Projection switches to Mercator and fits the selected country, which is filled a shade darker than its neighbours so the boundary of the decision is obvious. Surrounding countries stay visible but unlabelled.

How many cities. A country may show several — **eight is the hard ceiling**, and readability decides the real number. Cities are pins with names, so eight labels only work where they are geographically spread; a dense cluster of five reads worse than a clean four. The rule is: add cities while every label still sits clear of its neighbours at 390px, then stop. Ranking is by decision value, not catalogue size, and the top-ranked city is emphasised so the default choice is never ambiguous.

Pins. Each city is a pill with its name and attraction count; the top-ranked one is emphasised. Where cities crowd, the lower-ranked ones drop their count badge before they drop their label, and a city that still cannot be placed cleanly is held back from the map — it stays in the panel list, so it is never lost. Attraction clusters (*Ancient Rome*, *Food quarters*) may appear alongside a single-city country as category hints; tapping one opens the city, not a product.

Panel. The country row with its match label and reason, then the city list in the same ranked order as the pins, then a mandatory trade-off line — the honest cost of choosing this country under the active preference. Pin order and list order must always agree.

Google Maps comments

Section: Flat world projection (Natural Earth)

NOT POSSIBLE on the standard Google Maps basemap. Google Maps uses Mercator. We can create a visually similar flat experience, but not use the specified Natural Earth projection while retaining the normal Google basemap.

Section: Warm land / pale water / borders

Mostly possible. Google Cloud-based map styling supports colors and visibility for map features such as land, water, roads, buildings and POIs. The exact visual result may differ from the Figma/reference image.

Section: No provider labels / no city names / no roads

Mostly possible, with an important exception. We can hide many basemap features and labels through Google map styling. However, Google Maps attribution/branding must remain visible and must not be hidden or obscured.

Section: Labels never overlap; move, never drop

Not guaranteed natively. Google Advanced Markers support collision behavior, including hiding lower-priority markers/labels. They do not provide the exact rule “automatically reposition every label and never drop one.” If this exact behavior is required, we need our own label-positioning logic and custom HTML markers.

Section: Frame fitted to all destinations

Possible. Google Maps provides fitBounds-style viewport fitting. We can calculate bounds from our destination coordinates and fit the map to them.

Never at this level. Individual attraction pins, prices, or more than eight cities. If readability forces a cut, cut cities — never shrink the labels.

5 · Level 2 — City

Purpose. Show the two or three things in this city that we would actually send this traveller to, and start being specific about money.

Map treatment. At this zoom a country basemap carries no information, so the map deliberately stops imitating one. The surface becomes a light dotted field with the city centre marked, concentric distance rings, a scale bar in kilometres, and the city name set small beneath the centre dot. Attractions sit at their true coordinates — the geography is real even though the basemap is quiet.

How many attractions. Four winners per city, maximum. Not four of everything we sell — four that are genuinely relevant to the active preference, ranked by review volume within their category, so the ordering is earned by evidence rather than asserted by us. Fewer than four is a valid answer: a city with two real winners shows two. The number is a ceiling, never a quota to fill.

Pins. One per winner, with the attraction name and the number of products we keep there. Tier styling applies here too: an attraction that is a strong fit for the active preference reads as a best match; one that is not is labelled honestly rather than removed. Four labels is also the readability limit at this zoom — if they cannot be placed clearly, the lowest-ranked winner leaves the map and stays in the list.

Panel. Header states the selection openly — *Kraków · 3 attractions, Prioritised for Family*. Each row: photo, match label, a reason chip assembled from verified product facts (*Clear 1h 30m format*), attraction name and category, the fit explanation, then rating, review count and a **from** price. One trade-off line closes the list.

Worked example. Kraków under *Family*: Wieliczka Salt Mine and Wawel Castle both read as best match — one because it is an indoor afternoon in any weather, the other because it is flat ground in a ninety-minute format. Switch to *Culture & history* and Wieliczka drops to *Worth considering*, with a line saying which audience it is actually strongest for.

6 · Level 3 — Attraction & products

Purpose. Make the booking decision between two or three versions of the same attraction, and be explicit about what each one gives up.

Google Maps comments

Section: Mercator at Country level

Google Maps already uses Mercator. Therefore there is no real projection switch to implement. The requested switch only makes sense if the previous level uses a different projection such as Natural Earth—which Google Maps cannot provide as its standard basemap.

Section: Selected country filled darker

Possible. Google Maps supports data-driven styling for country/administrative boundaries, including custom fill and stroke styles, subject to boundary coverage and map-ID/vector-map setup.

Section: Attraction clusters / category hints

Possible as custom application overlays. These are not native Google POI clusters in the requested product-specific meaning. We would render our own cluster/category markers and handle their click behaviour.

Section: More than eight cities / readability cut

Possible. The eight-city limit is our application rule. Google can help with marker collision, but the exact “stop at 390px based on readability” rule must be implemented by us.

Map treatment. The frame stays at city scale rather than zooming into a single point — context is what makes comparison possible. The selected attraction is emphasised; its siblings stay visible in a quieter treatment (paler fill and border, never faded text) and remain tappable, so switching between attractions costs one tap.

How many products. Three is the cap, and a fourth is allowed only where the card set still reads cleanly — three genuinely different options beat four near-identical ones, and duplicates are removed before the cap is ever reached. Each product must differ on something a traveller can act on: duration, access level, price bracket or group size. If two options differ only in wording, one of them does not exist.

Panel — one card per product. Photo, title, then the fact row: rating, review count, duration, exact price. Below it, in this order: **Why this fits** (assembled from an approved template plus verified product facts), the **material trade-off**, the **review prioritisation block**, and a single priced CTA (*Check dates · from €49*).

Worked example. Wawel Castle under *Family* offers a 90-minute family walk at €32 (★4.9, 1,204 reviews) and a 2h 45m historian-led interior circuit at €58 (★4.8, 876). The second one carries the trade-off "longer duration and 140 stairs — we would not book this with young children". The recommendation and the reason it might be wrong sit in the same card.

Never at this level. More than one CTA per product, countdown timers, or scarcity copy that is not a verified fact.

7 · The preference row — the only input

A single horizontally scrolling row of preference chips sits above the map: *First visit*, *Family*, *Culture & history*, *Active*, *Budget-smart*. Each chip carries the number of destinations that come out as a strong match, so the consequence of tapping is visible before the tap. One selection at a time; the selected chip is solid navy.

Changing the preference re-ranks the pins, re-tints the map, rewrites every match label, reason chip, fit explanation and trade-off, reorders the list below, and updates the count line above the map. If the currently open destination is a poor fit for the new preference, the view returns to world level rather than leaving someone inside a recommendation we no longer stand behind.

Chips are 44px tall. They are the primary control of the whole section, so they are never compressed to fit more of them on screen — the row scrolls instead.

8 · Match labels and reason chips

Google Maps comments

Section: Light dotted field instead of a normal basemap

Not as a native Google map style. We can heavily simplify the Google basemap using styling and add our own dotted/grid-like visual layer, but a completely custom dotted surface is not the standard Google basemap. If the design requires a true custom map surface, that becomes a custom-map/tile approach.

Section: Distance rings / scale bar

Possible. Distance rings can be application overlays calculated from the city coordinate. Google Maps also supports map controls/scale information. The exact visual style shown in the design would be custom UI.

Section: Attractions at true coordinates

Possible. We can use latitude/longitude from our backend or Google Places data and position custom markers at those coordinates.

Match label	Chip treatment	Pin treatment
Best match	Solid red, white text	Red dot, red count badge, full-weight label
Best alternative	White with a navy outline	Navy dot and badge, full-weight label
Also fits	Warm grey fill, no border	Grey dot and badge, medium-weight label
Worth considering	White with a dashed border	Dashed pill, no count badge, still tappable

Reason chips sit beside the match label and name the specific reason, never a mood: *Strong family-compatible inventory*, *Essential first-trip icons*, *Shorter experience formats*, *Clear 3-hour format*, *Archaeologist-led access*, *Early-start formats*. One chip per row on the map panel; two maximum on an attraction row. Where a chip states a format or duration it is derived from the real product data, so it can never contradict the product list underneath.

Why this fits is assembled from approved templates and verified facts, not written freehand per destination. Where no authored variant exists for a preference, the template names the audience the place is genuinely strongest for — “Strongest for culture & history rather than family — ...”. That is the honest form of a non-match, and it is why nothing needs hiding.

9 · Trade-offs and review prioritisation

Material trade-off. Every country, city and product carries one. It must be material — something that would change a decision: *“380 steps down and a constant 14°C”*, *“longer duration and 140 stairs”*, *“starts at 19:30 — late for young children”*, *“five hours including 90 minutes each way in traffic”*. Set in a quiet grey block with a small trade-off label. Never a disclaimer, never legal small print.

Review prioritisation block. On every product card, in a shaded box: the label **Prioritised for: {preference}**, one short representative review, then the contextual snippet explaining *why these reviews* — “Reviews shown are from travellers with children under 12. 61% of them mention the 90-minute length.”

The label changes with the preference row, which means the same product can honestly show a different slice of its reviews to a family and to a culture traveller — while the star rating and review count stay fixed, because those are facts.

Google Maps comments

Section: Preference changes re-tint the map

Partially possible. We can dynamically change our own markers, country polygons, overlays and result ranking when the preference changes. However, changing the entire Google basemap style per user/session is not the same as changing custom markers; Cloud-based map styles are associated with Map IDs and are not intended as a per-user dynamic styling mechanism. For preference-specific tinting, use our own overlays/feature styling.

Section: Match labels / reason chips

Possible. These are custom HTML/UI elements and can be implemented outside the Google basemap.

Section: Review prioritisation block

Possible, but not a Google Maps feature. This is product/business logic and should be generated from our backend/recommendation data.

10 · Movement between levels

- **Down.** Tapping a pin or a panel row descends one level. Zoom in does the same, choosing the highest-ranked entity in view — zoom is a level control, not a magnifier.
- **Up.** Zoom out climbs one level and drops the selection it leaves behind. The breadcrumb above the map (*World › Poland › Kraków › Wawel Castle*) is fully clickable, so any level is one tap away.
- **Feedback.** Each transition confirms itself with a brief line over the map — “Kraków · 3 attractions prioritised”, “Re-ranked for culture & history”. It states what changed, never “loading”.
- **Panning** never changes level and never opens anything: a drag of more than a few pixels cancels the tap.

11 · States to design

- **Poster / first paint.** The map loads behind a static poster so it never blocks the first render. The poster says what is coming, not “please wait”.
- **Single-match preference.** When only one destination is a strong match, the map still frames all covered destinations. It must never collapse onto one point or come back empty.
- **No map.** If the map cannot render, the crawlable list below it is the section. It carries the same match labels, the same order, and real links.
- **Empty photography.** Every image is a drop slot until real photography lands. No stock, no illustration, no AI imagery.

12 · Non-negotiables

Touch targets	44px minimum for every control. Map pins stay visually small; a tap within 22px resolves to the nearest pin, so the target is large without the hit areas overlapping.
Contrast	4.5:1 on all functional text, including match labels and the smallest metadata. De-emphasis is done with fill and border, never by fading text.
Basemap	Own vector geometry, Rosotravel styling. No third-party map branding and no provider POI labels anywhere on the surface.
Section height	Map roughly 200px on a 390px screen, with one results panel that scrolls internally. Descending a level must not lengthen the page.

Google Maps comments

Section: Zoom in = move to next business level

Possible as application behaviour, but not native Google Maps behaviour. Google zoom normally changes map scale. We can listen to zoom changes and map them to our L0/L1/L2/L3 state, but this is custom logic and needs careful handling to avoid surprising users.

Section: Breadcrumb / pan / tap behaviour

Possible. These are normal application interactions. We can distinguish drag from click and control which actions change the selected level.

Section: Static poster / no-map fallback

Possible. This is frontend rendering and SEO architecture, not a Google Maps limitation.

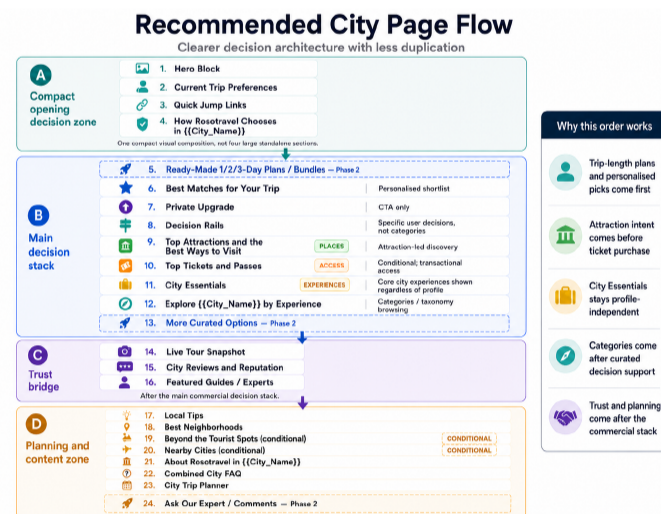
Section: No third-party map branding

NOT POSSIBLE if using Google Maps content. Google requires Google Maps attribution/logo/text to remain visible and legible. We cannot remove or hide Google attribution just to make the map look fully white-label.

Indexability	Ranking and copy adapt to the preference; the page's indexable structure and routing targets do not. Preference is a session signal, never a URL.
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VI. City page

1. General ordering



2. Decision rails and what we skipped

- <https://stellular-dusk-25ac33.netlify.app/>

3. City Essentials:

Purpose

Provide one stable city-level shortlist of **core bookable experiences** worth considering regardless of the currently active Audience or Intent profile.

Google Maps comments

Section: Indexability / preference is never a URL

Possible. This is an application/SEO architecture decision and is independent of Google Maps.

Section: City page content

Possible. The city-page sections are normal web content and can sit above/below the Google map.